

School entry is solved. Only 36% of 16–17-year-olds sit in Class 11 or 12.

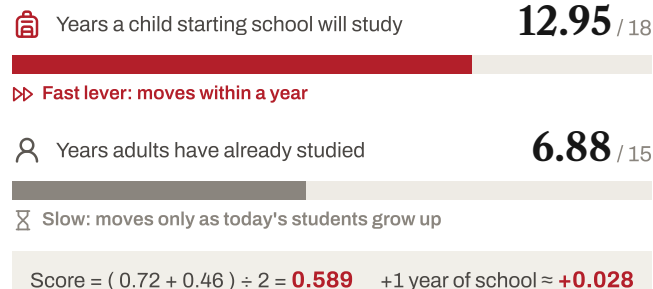
India's score is 0.589. Nearly all the years it is missing sit after Class 10, and students leave for money and work, not distance.

SAME 100 TEENAGERS, AGED 16–17

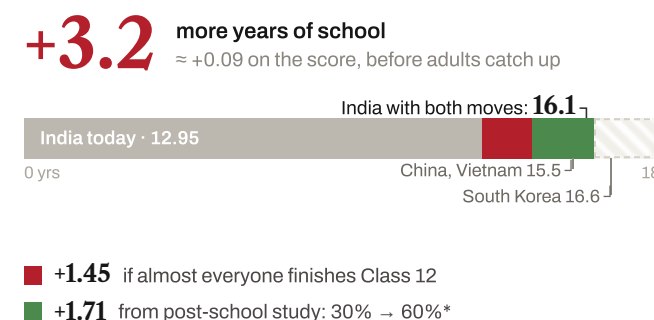


The headline 58.4% counts anyone in Class 11–12, at any age. *UDISE+ does not publish the age-by-class split; this residual includes students enrolled elsewhere. We think over-age students in lower classes are a large share.

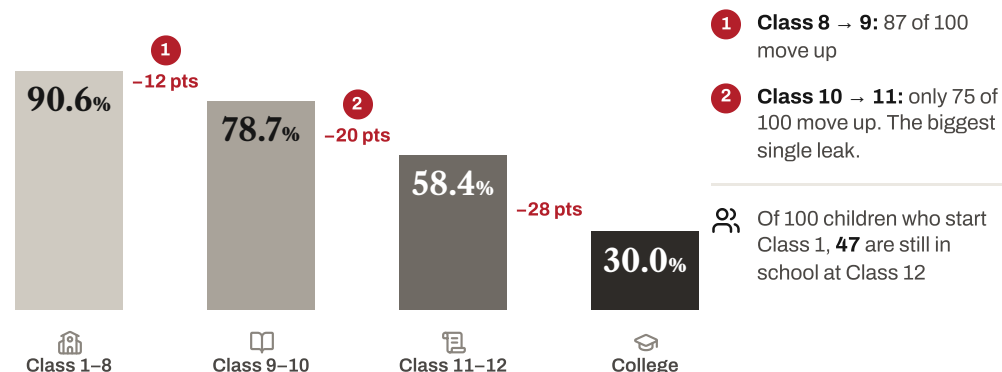
HOW THE SCORE IS BUILT



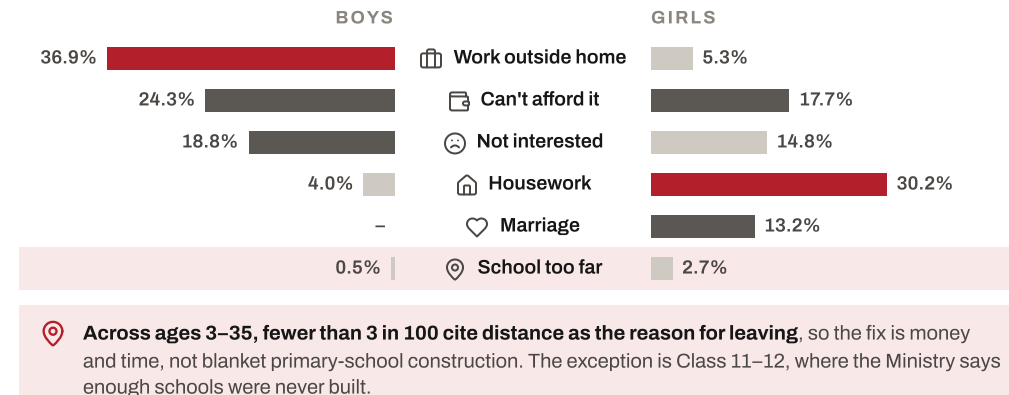
THE YEARS INDIA IS LEAVING ON THE TABLE



WHERE STUDENTS FALL OFF THE LADDER · enrolment by stage



WHY THEY LEAVE: MONEY AND WORK, NOT DISTANCE



A note on the brief's numbers. 68.5% and 8.2% cover Classes 9–12 counted together. Counted separately, Classes 9–10 are 78.7% and 11–12 are 58.4%; the old Class 9–10 dropout measure is 11.5%. We use the separate figures, on which the problem looks bigger, not smaller.

Sources: UDISE+ 2024-25 (Tables 6.1, 6.4, 6.6, 6.13–6.15); AISHE 2023-24; UNDP Human Development Report 2025; UNESCO Institute for Statistics; NSS 75th round (2017-18, ages 3–35, main reason for leaving); ASER 2024. *Post-school study is a college-equivalent participation rate (AISHE college-enrolment basis); each point adds an estimated 0.057 years; team calculation.

Two of these three moves add 3.2 years of school, for 0.18% of GDP a year.

Staying and progressing lift the score directly. Learning decides who stays. Measuring properly proves any of it worked.



01 Stay till 12

MOVES THE SCORE DIRECTLY · +1.45 YEARS

Students moving from Class 10 to Class 11

TODAY 75% → 2030 85% → 2035 95%

✓ Bihar bicycles: girls' Class 9 enrolment +5.2 pts

✓ Morocco cash for school: dropout -7.6 pts



02 Learn to stay

DECIDES WHO STAYS · NOT IN THE FORMULA

Class 3 children reading at their own level

TODAY 23% → 2030 40% → 2035 60%

✓ Children who score higher drop out far less

⚠ No Indian study yet proves teaching stops dropout



03 Open the next rung

MOVES THE SCORE DIRECTLY · +1.71 YEARS

Young people studying after school

TODAY 30% → 2030 40% → 2035 50%

✓ Tamil Nadu stipend: girls to college 45% → 74% after introduction*

⚠ 13% of graduates jobless vs 3-4% overall

WHERE EACH MOVE LANDS IN A STUDENT'S LIFE

CLASS 1-5

CLASS 6-8

CLASS 9-10

CLASS 11-12

COLLEGE & SKILLS

WORK

Stay

Cash 8 → 9

Cash 10 → 11

Teachers first

Bicycles, school 3 km+

Support for girls at risk ages

Learn

Teach at the level they are at · Class 3-8

Second chance at boards · 65 lakh fail Class 10 or 12 a year

Catch-up, Class 6

Catch-up, Class 9

Progress

Stipend on reaching college

Apprenticeship degrees

Count jobs, not seats

Grow where firms hire

WHAT MAKES IT WORK

Measure and manage

📋 Track every child by school ID and flag the ones slipping

👁 Publish the honest number next to the headline one

💰 Pay for learning as extra money, never a condition on the basics

🔍 Go district by district, checked by people who did not teach

WHAT CAN WAIT



New primary schools

98% of 6-14s already enrolled



Tablets, smart classes

no gain unless teaching changes



More skills seats alone

33% of polytechnic students job-ready



Adult literacy drives

barely move the score



Passing everyone

hides failure, does not fix it

WHAT THE WHOLE THING COSTS

₹63,200 crore a year

0.18% of GDP · 1.5× Samagra Shiksha

Teachers 62%

Stipends 15%

Cash 12%

Learning 8%

Meals, bikes 2%

*Tamil Nadu: before/after comparison, not a causal estimate. Sources: Muralidharan & Prakash (Bihar bicycles); Benhassine et al. (Morocco Tayssir); Cueto et al., Young Lives; Ministry of Education board results; Tamil Nadu Planning Commission; PLFS 2023-24 via Data for India; India Skills Report 2026; UNESCO Institute for Statistics; GEEAP Smart Buys 2023; ASER 2024. Costs are a team model built from UDISE+ 2024-25 enrolment and published unit costs; every assumption can be checked.

Team MU · 2 / 3

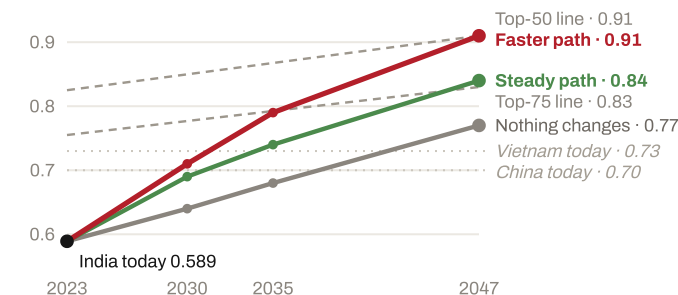
Start in six states for ₹18,400 crore; only the faster path reaches top-50 territory.

One destination, two speeds. 2030 proves it works where the gap is widest, 2035 takes it national, 2047 makes school to age 18 normal.

THE THREE STAGES · every 2030 and 2035 number is a target we commit to, not a prediction

	2030 PROVE IT six states	2035 SCALE IT national	2047 KEEP IT the norm
Stay	85 of 100 move up from Class 10 · right to school to age 18 · teachers first	95 of 100 move up · Classes 11–12 enrolment ratio 90%	Almost every child in school to 18
Learn	Class 3 reading 23% → 40% · catch-up to Class 8	Reading 60% · board failures halved	Money follows learning · 6% of GDP on education
Progress	40% study after school · stipends and apprenticeship degrees begin	50% , the national target · stipends everywhere · online credit	60% steady path · ~90% for the faster path
Score	steady 0.69 · faster 0.71	steady 0.74 · faster 0.79	steady 0.84 · faster 0.91

INDIA'S SCORE AGAINST A MOVING TARGET



Said plainly. The steady path lands just inside the projected top 75. Only the faster path reaches the top-50 line, with nothing to spare, so read it as top-50 territory, not a guaranteed rank.

WHO DOES WHAT



START HERE, THEN SCALE

₹18,400 crore a year

1 Bihar	38%	4 Gujarat	47%
2 Assam	44%	5 Jharkhand	49%
3 Madhya Pr.	45%	6 W. Bengal	52%

Class 11–12 enrolment vs 58% nationally

30% of Class 9–12 students · **1.74 lakh** teaching posts

0.05% of GDP · 44% of a year of Samagra Shiksha

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Team MU · Manya Jain · Shruti Kalani · Sambhav Sharma | Scores are team estimates built from the HDR 2025 starting point of 12.95 and 6.88 years, closing the 1.45-year school gap and adding 0.057 years for each point of study after school. The top-50 and top-75 lines are projected from how fast the 50th- and 75th-ranked countries have moved. Costs from UDISE+ 2024-25 enrolment and published unit costs. Map boundaries are indicative.